



## “...THE GREATEST FAILURE OF THE WEST SINCE THE 1930s.”

Richard Holbrooke, US Assistant Secretary of State, on the Bosnian crisis

armed struggle against British rule in Northern Ireland. The ceasefire indicated the IRA's willingness to enter into **peace talks** on the political future of the province. The Irish prime minister, Albert Reynolds, asked loyalist paramilitaries to toe the same line. However, loyalists were suspicious of this declaration and feared that Northern Ireland's position in Great Britain would be threatened, but in the end, on October 13, they announced their own ceasefire.

War continued in Bosnia and Herzegovina, and on February 5, a marketplace in downtown **Sarajevo was devastated** by a mortar bomb, killing 68 people and injuring a further 200. The international community condemned the atrocity, which



### Brazil's Samba Boys

Marcio Santos of Brazil holds the FIFA World Cup trophy to celebrate victory. Brazil, known as the Samba Boys, beat Italy in the final.



### Eurostar's maiden run

The high-speed rail service, Eurostar, which travels through the Channel Tunnel, linking England and France, made its maiden voyage in 1994.

was believed to have been carried out by Serbians.

On December 11, Russian president Boris Yeltsin ordered troops into the **rebel region of Chechnya** to prevent it from breaking away from the country. This Muslim-dominated region had **declared its independence** from Moscow three years before under the leadership of General Dzhokhar Dudayev.

On September 19, the **US led an invasion force in Haiti** to bring the military junta to an end and restore democracy under President Aristide, exiled three years earlier. No shots were fired.

On May 6, **Queen Elizabeth of Britain and President Francois Mitterand** (1916–96) of France formally **opened the Channel Tunnel**. Linking England and France, the tunnel took eight years to build.

**MS Estonia**, a car and passenger ferry, **sank in the Baltic Sea** on September 28—852 passengers died, half of whom were Swedes.

An investigation into the accident found that stormy weather, poor maintenance, and high speed contributed to the disaster.

Millions watched in horror as the Formula One racing champion, **Ayrton Senna**, plowed off the track at the San Marino Grand Prix on May 1, in a **fatal crash**. A state funeral was held in his home city of São Paulo. Senna was a national hero in Brazil and had given millions to help the country's underprivileged children.



### AFRICAN NATIONAL CONGRESS

Founded in 1912 with the aim of increasing the rights of black South Africans, the African National Congress (ANC) came to power in 1994, when Nelson Mandela was elected president of South Africa. The ANC still enjoys majority support, but is troubled by internal power struggles between Thabo Mbeki and Jacob Zuma, the two successors of Mandela, and the challenges of poverty and AIDS.

**THE CITY OF KOBE IN JAPAN WAS DEVASTATED BY AN EARTHQUAKE** on January 17. Measuring 7.2 on the Richter scale, it resulted in hundreds of deaths and over 13,000 injuries.

**Barings**, a British investment bank, was **declared bankrupt** after an employee, Nick Leeson, risked huge amounts of money on the Nikkei, the Japanese stock market index. The index collapsed after the Kobe earthquake.

On March 20, **Turkey launched a major military offensive**, involving 35,000 troops, against the **Kurds** in northern Iraq. This was an attempt to pursue rebel Turkish Kurds who had fled into the region and prevent them from setting up permanent bases there. The Kurds had been engaged in an armed struggle for a separate homeland since 1984 and had grievances over the lack of rights for Kurds within Turkey.



### The Ebola scare

An outbreak of Ebola occurred in 1995 in Zaire. Of the 315 cases identified, 254 died, giving a fatality rate of 81 percent.



### Oklahoma bombing

A massive truck bomb exploded in front of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City on April 19. It was felt 30 miles (48km) away.

The Turkish government hold the separatist **Kurdistan Worker's Party (PKK)** responsible for more than 30,000 deaths over the course of the conflict. Repeated military operations by Turkey against the PKK have not proved effective and the conflict continues.

A powerful **bomb exploded in Oklahoma City** on April 19, killing 168 people. Timothy McVeigh, a Gulf War veteran, was convicted of the attack. The bombing was in reaction to the government's handling of the **Waco siege** (see 1993).

**Srebrenica**, a Muslim enclave and UN-designated safe haven, was **overrun by Bosnian Serbs** on July 10 and "ethnically cleansed." In December, the leaders of Bosnia, Serbia, and Croatia signed the **Dayton Peace Accord** in Paris, bringing three years of war in Bosnia to an end.

